

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12403648
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Harayama; Kenji et al.

Repairing method for shaped object, shaping system, and manufacturing method for attachment member

Abstract

A repairing method for a shaped object includes: preparing a defective portion part to be attached to a defective portion in a repair target shaped object; creating a repair patch which is an attachment member to be attached to at least one part of the repair target shaped object; and attaching the repair patch to cover at least one part of a boundary portion of the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part; where at least one part of the repair target shaped object is colored. The repair patch including a colored layer and an adhesive layer is created using a shaping device capable of shaping a shaped object colored by a layered shaping method, and the colored layer is colored and formed in accordance with a color of a portion covered by the repair patch in a shaped object.

Inventors:	Harayama; Kenji (Nagano, JP), Furuse; Masayuki (Nagano, JP)
Applicant:	MIMAKI ENGINEERING CO., LTD. (Nagano, JP)
Family ID:	87559930
Assignee:	MIMAKI ENGINEERING CO., LTD. (Nagano, JP)
Appl. No.:	18/167883
Filed:	February 12, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230256666 A1	Aug. 17, 2023

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2022-023047	Feb. 17, 2022
----	-------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **B29C64/112** (20170101); **B29C64/135** (20170101); **B29C64/393** (20170101);
B33Y10/00 (20150101); B33Y40/20 (20200101); B33Y50/02 (20150101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B29C64/112** (20170801); **B29C64/135** (20170801); **B29C64/393** (20170801);
B33Y10/00 (20141201); B33Y40/20 (20200101); B33Y50/02 (20141201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B29C (64/112); B29C (64/135); B29C (64/393); B29C (64/386); B29C (73/10); B33Y
(10/00)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2017/0368770	12/2016	Harrier	N/A	B33Y 80/00
2020/0166907	12/2019	Frederick	N/A	B33Y 10/00
2020/0307096	12/2019	Simonin	N/A	B29C 73/24
2021/0237337	12/2020	Zaldivar	N/A	B33Y 80/00

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2003035021	12/2002	JP	N/A
2014025271	12/2013	JP	N/A
2015071282	12/2014	JP	N/A
2019194004	12/2018	JP	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

“Notification of Reason for Rejection of Japan Counterpart Application”, issued on Jun. 3, 2025,
with English translation thereof, p. 1-p. 10. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: McNally; Daniel

Attorney, Agent or Firm: JCIPRNET

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims the priority benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-023047,
filed on Feb. 17, 2022. The entirety of the above-mentioned patent application is hereby
incorporated by reference herein and made a part of this specification.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to a repairing method for a shaped object, a shaping system, and a

manufacturing method for an attachment member.

DESCRIPTION OF THE BACKGROUND ART

(3) Conventionally, a shaping device (3D printer) for shaping a shaped object using an inkjet head is known (see e.g., Japanese Unexamined Patent Publication No. 2015-071282). In such a shaping device, for example, the shaped object is shaped through a layered shaping method by overlapping a plurality of ink layers formed by an inkjet head.

SUMMARY

(4) In the case of a shaped object shaped by the shaping device, for example, even if the shaped object is damaged, the same shaped object can usually be shaped again. On the other hand, depending on the intended purpose of the shaped object and the manner of being damaged, it may be more desirable to repair the damaged shaped object than to re-shape the same shaped object. Furthermore, in this case, for example, it is conceivable to repair the shaped object by adhering the damaged area. However, when repairing the shaped object in this manner, for example, the strength at the repair position decreases, and thus the same area may be easily damaged again. Therefore, it is desired to repair the shaped object by a more appropriate method. The present disclosure provides a repairing method for a shaped object, a shaping system, and a manufacturing method for an attachment member.

(5) The inventor of the present application conducted intensive research on a method for repairing a shaped object shaped by a shaping device. Then, the inventors have considered attaching a patch-shaped member (hereinafter, referred to as a repair patch) for reinforcement on at least one part of the periphery of the damaged area rather than simply performing adhering on the damaged area. However, in this case, it is conceivable that the appearance of the shaped object after repair is deteriorated by the repair patch remaining on the surface of the shaped object after the repair. In particular, when repairing the shaped object in which the surface is colored by such a method, the appearance may be greatly deteriorated. On the other hand, the inventor of the present application considered creating a repair patch in accordance with the repair position in the shaped object to be repaired by further intensive research. Furthermore, in this case, the inventor considered creating a repair patch in a state of being colored in accordance with the repair position in the shaped object to be repaired using a shaping device capable of shaping the shaped object same as or similar to the shaped object to be repaired. According to such configuration, for example, the strength of the shaped object after the repair can be appropriately increased by using the repair patch. Furthermore, for example, the repair patch attached to the shaped object can be appropriately prevented from being excessively conspicuous by using the repair patch colored in accordance with the repair position. Furthermore, for example, the colored repair patch corresponding to the repair position can be easily and appropriately created by creating the repair patch using the shaping device.

(6) Through further thorough research, the inventor of the present application found features necessary for obtaining such effects and contrived the present disclosure. In order to solve the above problem, the present disclosure provides a repairing method for a shaped object for repairing a shaped object shaped by a shaping device, the method including a preparing stage of preparing a defective portion part which is a member to be attached to a defective area in a repair target shaped object which is the shaped object where a damage in which one part is defected has occurred; an attachment member creating stage of creating an attachment member which is a member to be attached to at least one part of surfaces of the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part; and an attaching stage of attaching the attachment member so as to cover at least one part of a boundary portion between the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part in a state where the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part are brought into contact with each other; where at least one part of a surface of the repair target shaped object is colored; in the attachment member creating stage, the attachment member including an adhesive layer which is a layer for adhering the attachment member to the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part, and a colored layer which is a layer subjected to coloring is created using a shaping

device capable of shaping the shaped object colored by a layered shaping method; and a colored layer is colored and formed according to a color of a portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object.

(7) When configured in such manner, for example, the strength of the repair target shaped object after repair can be appropriately enhanced by attaching the attachment member to at least one part of the repair position in the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, by using the attachment member including the colored layer and the adhesive layer, for example, the shaping device can easily and appropriately create an attachment member that is appropriately colored and can be adhered to the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, by coloring and forming the colored layer of the attachment member in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object, for example, the attachment member can be appropriately prevented from being excessively conspicuous in the repair target shaped object after the repair. Thus, according to such configuration, for example, the repair on the repair target shaped object can be easily and appropriately carried out.

(8) In this configuration, for example, it is conceivable to use a patch-shaped member (repair patch) as the attachment member. According to such configuration, for example, the attachment member can be easily and appropriately attached to the correction target shaped object. It is conceivable to use, for example, a portion or the like deviated from the correction target shaped object due to damage can be considered as a defective portion part. With this configuration, for example, the defective portion part can be easily and appropriately prepared. In this case, for example, a portion excluding the defective portion part from the shaped object before the damage can be considered as a repair target shaped object. The repair target shaped object can be considered as, for example, a configuration corresponding to at least one part of the shaped object of before the damage occurs. Furthermore, depending on the state of damage, the quality required for repair, and the like, consideration is made to use a part newly created for repair instead of one part of the shaped object before the damage occurred as the defective portion part. In this case, for example, consideration is made to further create (shape) the defective portion part with the shaping device used for creating the attachment member. Furthermore, the repairing method for the shaped object preferably further includes, for example, an adhering stage of adhering the defective portion part to the repair target shaped object. In this case, it is conceivable to perform the operation of the attaching stage after performing the operation of the adhering stage. According to such configuration, for example, the defective portion part can be more appropriately fixed to the repair target shaped object.

(9) Furthermore, the repairing method for the shaped object preferably further includes, for example, a repair position designating stage of receiving designation of a repair position, which is a position to be repaired in the repair target shaped object, from the user. In this case, in the repair position designating stage, for example, an image showing at least one part of the repair target shaped object is displayed on the image display device, and the designation of the repair position is received from the user. In the attachment member creating stage, for example, the shape of the attachment member and the color of each position in the colored layer are determined in accordance with the repair position designated in the repair position designating stage. Furthermore, the attachment member is created based on the determined shape and color. With this configuration, for example, the attachment member adapted to the repair position can be more appropriately created based on the designation of the user.

(10) Furthermore, in the attachment member creating stage, for example, it is conceivable to create the attachment member based on the data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object. In this case, the time of shaping the repair target shaped object can be considered as, for example, the time of shaping at which the shaped object before the damage occurs is shaped by the shaping device. Furthermore, for example, consideration is made to use shaped object data indicating the shape and color of the shaped object as such data. More specifically, in this case, in the attachment member creating stage, for example, the color of each position in the colored layer

of the attachment member is determined based on the shaped object data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object, the data indicating the shape and color of the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, the attachment member is created based on the determined color. According to such configuration, for example, the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object can be appropriately acquired based on the shaped object data. Thus, for example, the colored layer of the attachment member can be appropriately colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object.

(11) Furthermore, for example, consideration is made to directly acquire the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object from the repair target shaped object without using the shaped object data. In this case, the repairing method for the shaped object further includes, for example, a data generating stage of generating scan data which is data obtained by 3D scanning the repair target shaped object. In this case, in the attachment member creating stage, for example, the color of each position in the colored layer of the attachment member is determined based on the scan data generated in the data generating stage. Furthermore, the attachment member is created based on the determined color. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object can be appropriately acquired. Thus, for example, the colored layer of the attachment member can be appropriately colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, in the data generating stage, for example, it is conceivable to have the defective portion part as a scan target. More specifically, in this case, for example, it is conceivable to carry out the 3D scan in a state where the defective portion part is attached to the repair target shaped object. According to such configuration, for example, the color of the portion covered by the attachment member in the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part can be appropriately acquired. Thus, for example, the color of each position of the colored layer of the attachment member can be more appropriately determined.

(12) Furthermore, in this configuration, the repair target shaped object includes, for example, a region to be colored subjected to coloring at a surface of the repair target shaped object, and a light reflecting region formed on an inner side of the region to be colored in a light reflecting manner. As the shaping device used in the attachment member creating stage, it is conceivable to use a device capable of shaping such a shaped object. More specifically, as the shaping device used in the attachment member creating stage, for example, it is conceivable to use a device that ejects an ultraviolet-curable material as the shaping material. In this case, the shaping device includes, for example, a plurality of ejection heads each of which ejects the shaping material, and an ultraviolet light source that irradiates the ejected shaping material with ultraviolet light. Furthermore, the plurality of ejection heads include at least a coloring material head that ejects a color material which is the colored shaping material for coloring, and a light reflective material head that ejects a light reflective material which is the shaping material having light reflectivity. According to such configuration, for example, the attachment member having a configuration adapted to the repair target shaped object can be appropriately created.

(13) Furthermore, in this case, the ultraviolet-curable material used as the shaping material can be brought to a state having adhesiveness, for example, by being irradiated with the ultraviolet light of a smaller amount of light than when being completely cured. In this case, it is conceivable to form the adhesive layer of the attachment member by bringing the shaping material into such a state having adhesiveness. More specifically, in this case, in the attachment member creating stage, for example, the colored layer is formed using at least the color material ejected from the coloring material head. It is conceivable to form the colored layer by, for example, emitting a sufficient amount of ultraviolet light to cure the shaping material to a state not having adhesiveness.

Furthermore, in this case, it is conceivable to form the adhesive layer using the shaping material ejected from any of the plurality of ejection heads. In addition, at the time of forming the adhesive

layer, it is conceivable to increase the viscosity of the shaping material to a state having adhesiveness by irradiating the shaping material with ultraviolet light from an ultraviolet light source. Furthermore, in this case, for example, it is conceivable to cure the shaping material in the adhesive layer by further irradiating the attachment member with the ultraviolet light after attaching the attachment member to the repair target shaped object in the attaching stage. According to such configuration, for example, the adhesive layer of the attachment member can be appropriately formed using the ultraviolet-curable shaping material. Furthermore, the attachment member can be appropriately fixed to the repair target shaped object by further emitting the ultraviolet light after attaching the attachment member to the repair target shaped object to complete the curing of the adhesive layer.

(14) Furthermore, in a modified example of the manner of forming the adhesive layer of the attachment member, consideration is also made to form the adhesive layer with an adhesive material that is not used as a shaping material at the time of shaping a normal shaped object. In this case, the material not used as the shaping material at the time of shaping the normal shaped object can be considered as, for example, a material not used when shaping the same shaped object as the repair target shaped object. The adhesive material is, for example, a material of the adhesive layer in the attachment member, and can also be considered as a material or the like that is not used when forming the same region as each of the region to be colored and the light reflecting region in the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, in this case, the shaping device used to create the attachment member further includes, for example, an adhesive material head that ejects the adhesive material. In the attachment member creating stage, for example, the colored layer is formed using at least the color material ejected from the coloring material head. Then, an adhesive layer is formed using the adhesive material ejected from the adhesive material head. Even when configured in such manner, the attachment member including the colored layer and the adhesive layer can be appropriately created. As such an adhesive material, for example, it is conceivable to use an ultraviolet-curable material or the like that maintains adhesiveness even when ultraviolet light is sufficiently emitted and curing is completed. More specifically, as such an adhesive material, for example, it is conceivable to use a liquid same as or similar to a known ultraviolet-curable ink (primer ink) for forming a base. Furthermore, for example, consideration is made to use an adhesive material that is not ultraviolet curable, and the like for the adhesive material that is not used as the shaping material at the time of shaping the normal shaped object. When using such an adhesive material, for example, it is conceivable to complete the attachment of the attachment member to the repair target shaped object without further emitting the ultraviolet light in the attaching stage. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the attachment member can be appropriately attached to the repair target shaped object.

(15) Furthermore, as a configuration of the present disclosure, it is conceivable to use a shaping system, a manufacturing method for an attachment member, and the like having the features similar to the above. In this case as well, for example, effects similar to the above can be obtained.

(16) According to the present disclosure, for example, repair of a damaged shaped object can be easily and appropriately carried out.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIGS. 1A to 1C are views describing a shaping system **10** used in a repairing method for a shaped object according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1A shows one example of a configuration of the shaping system **10**.

(3) FIG. 1B shows one example of a configuration of a main part of a shaping device **12** in the shaping system **10**.

- (4) FIG. 1C illustrates an example of a configuration of a head unit **102**.
- (5) FIGS. 2A to 2C are views describing a shaped object **50** shaped by the shaping device **12** of the present example and an operation of repairing the shaped object **50**. FIG. 2A shows one example of a configuration of the shaped object **50**. FIG. 2B shows one example of how damage occurs in the shaped object **50**. FIG. 2C illustrates an example of a configuration of the repair patch **300**.
- (6) FIGS. 3A to 3D are views describing the operation of repairing the shaped object **50** using the repair patch **300** in more detail. FIGS. 3A and 3B illustrate an example of a configuration of the repair patch **300**. FIG. 3C illustrates an example of a manner of attaching the repair patch **300** to the shaped object **50** to be repaired. FIG. 3D is a cross-sectional view showing an example of a configuration of a cross-section of the shaped object **50** and the repair patch **300** at a position of attaching the repair patch **300**.
- (7) FIG. 4 is a flow chart showing an example of an operation of repairing the shaped object **50**.
- (8) FIG. 5 is a flowchart showing an example of an operation of generating patch data.
- (9) FIGS. 6A to 6C are views describing a modified example of the configuration and the like of the repair patch **300**. FIGS. 6A and 6B illustrate a modified example of the configuration of the repair patch **300**. FIG. 6C illustrates a modified example of the configuration of the head unit **102** in the shaping device **12**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

- (10) Hereinafter, an embodiment according to the present disclosure will be described with reference to the drawings. FIGS. 1A to 1C are views describing a shaping system **10** used in a repairing method for a shaped object according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 1A illustrates an example of a configuration of the shaping system **10**. FIG. 1B shows an example of a configuration of a main part of a shaping device **12** in the shaping system **10**. In the present example, the shaping system **10** is a shaping system for shaping a stereoscopic shaped object, and includes a shaping device **12** and a control PC **14**. The shaped object shaped in the shaping system **10** can be considered as, for example, a stereoscopic three-dimensional structure. Furthermore, in the present example, the shaping system **10** is configured by a plurality of devices, the shaping device **12** and the control PC **14**. In a modified example of the shaping system **10**, the shaping system **10** may be configured by a single device. In this case, for example, it is conceivable to configure the shaping system **10** with a single shaping device **12** also having the function of the control PC **14**. The shaping system **10** may further include devices other than the shaping device **12** and the control PC **14**.
- (11) In the shaping system **10**, the shaping device **12** is a device that executes shaping of a shaped object, and shapes a shaped object according to the control of the control PC **14**. In the present example, the shaping device **12** is a full-color shaping device capable of shaping a shaped object colored in full color, and receives shaped object data, which is data indicating a shaped object to shape, from the control PC **14**, and shapes the shaped object based on the shaped object data. Furthermore, the shaping device **12** is a shaping device (3D printer) that shapes a stereoscopic shaped object **50** through a layered shaping method, and for example, as shown in FIG. 1B, includes a head unit **102**, a shaping table **104**, a scanning driving unit **106**, and a control unit **110**. In this case, the layered shaping method can be considered as, for example, a method of shaping the shaped object **50** by overlapping layers formed of the shaping material. Other than the points described below, the shaping device **12** may have a structure identical or similar to a known shaping device. More specifically, other than the points described below, the shaping device **12** may have a feature identical or similar to a known shaping device that carries out shaping by ejecting a droplet to become the material of the shaped object **50** using an inkjet head.
- (12) Furthermore, other than the illustrated configuration, the shaping device **12** may further include, for example, various types of configurations necessary for the shaping, and the like of the shaped object **50**.
- (13) The head unit **102** has a configuration that ejects the material of the shaped object **50**. In the

present example, ink is used as the material of the shaped object **50**. For example, the ink can be considered as a functional liquid or the like. Moreover, in the present example, for example, the ink can be considered as liquid, and the like ejected from the inkjet head. More specifically, the head unit **102** ejects ink that cures according to predetermined conditions from a plurality of inkjet heads as a material of the shaped object **50**. Then, by curing the ink after landing, the respective layers forming the shaped object **50** are formed in an overlapping manner, and a shaped object is shaped through the layered shaping method. Moreover, in the present example, an ultraviolet-curable ink (UV ink) that cures from a liquid state by irradiation of ultraviolet light is used as the ink. In this case, the ultraviolet-curable ink is an example of an ultraviolet curable shaping material.

Furthermore, the head unit **102** further ejects a material of a support layer **52** in addition to the material of the shaped object **50**. The head unit **102** thereby forms the support layer **52** at a periphery of the shaped object **50**, and the like as necessary.

(14) The support layer **52** can be considered as, for example, a layered structural object that supports at least one part of the shaped object **50** being shaped. The support layer **52** is formed as necessary at the time of shaping the shaped object **50** and removed after the shaping is completed.

(15) The shaping table **104** is a table-shaped member that supports the shaped object **50** being shaped and is disposed at a position facing the inkjet head in the head unit **102**, and has the shaped object **50** being shaped and the support layer **52** placed on the upper surface thereof. Furthermore, in the present example, the shaping table **104** has a configuration of being movable in a layering direction (Z direction in the figure), and moves in the layering direction in accordance with the progress of the shaping of the shaped object **50** by being driven by the scanning driving unit **106**. In this case, the layering direction can be considered as, for example, the direction in which the shaping materials are layered in the layered shaping method. More specifically, in the present example, the layering direction is a direction orthogonal to the main scanning direction (Y direction in the figure) and the sub scanning direction (X direction in the figure) preset in the shaping device **12**.

(16) The scanning driving unit **106** is a driving unit that causes the head unit **102** to perform a scanning operation of relatively moving with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped. In the present example, relatively moving with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped can be considered as, for example, relatively moving with respect to the shaping table **104**, and the like. Furthermore, causing the head unit **102** to perform the scanning operation can be considered as, for example, causing the inkjet head of the head unit **102** to perform the scanning operation, and the like. In addition, in the present example, the scanning driving unit **106** causes the head unit **102** to perform the main scan (Y scanning), the sub scan (X scanning), and the layering direction scan (Z scanning) as the scanning operation. In this case, the main scan can be considered as, for example, an operation of ejecting the ink while relatively moving in the main scanning direction with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped. The sub scan can be considered as, for example, an operation of relatively moving with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped in the sub-scanning direction orthogonal to the main scanning direction. Furthermore, the sub scan can be considered as, for example, an operation of relatively moving with respect to the shaping table **104** in the sub-scanning direction by a preset feed amount, or the like. In the present example, the scanning driving unit **106** causes the head unit **102** to form a layer of ink by causing the head unit **102** to perform the main scan and the sub scan. Furthermore, the layering direction scan can be considered as, for example, an operation of relatively moving in the layering direction with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped. The scanning driving unit **106** adjusts the relative position of the inkjet head with respect to the shaped object **50** being shaped in the layering direction by causing the head unit **102** to perform the layering direction scan in accordance with the progress of the shaping operation.

(17) The control unit **110** has a configuration including, for example, a CPU of the shaping device **12**, and controls the shaping operation of the shaped object **50** by controlling each unit of the

shaping device **12**. Furthermore, in the present example, the control unit **110** generates slice data, which is data indicating a cross-section of the shaped object **50** to shape, based on the shaped object data received from the control PC **14**. Then, in the operation of forming each layer of ink configuring the shaped object **50**, each inkjet head is caused to eject ink used for shaping the shaped object by controlling the operation of each inkjet head in the head unit **102** based on the slice data. According to the present example, for example, the shaping of the shaped object **50** can be appropriately executed.

(18) Furthermore, in the present example, the shaping device **12** further creates a repair patch, which is a member used for repairing the shaped object, other than the normal shaped object. In this case, the normal shaped object can be considered as, for example, a shaped object or the like shaped in the shaping device **12** by the normal shaping operation.

(19) Furthermore, the repair patch can be considered as, for example, a member or the like used when repairing a shaped object shaped in the past by the shaping device **12** that creates the repair patch or another shaping device. In the present example, the operation of creating a repair patch, the manner of using the repair patch, and the like will be described in more detail later.

(20) Furthermore, in the shaping system **10**, the control PC **14** is a computer (host PC) that controls the operation of the shaping device **12**, and controls the shaping operation by the shaping device **12** by providing the shaped object data to the shaping device **12**. Furthermore, in the present example, the control PC **14** includes the display unit **22**, the operation unit **24**, and the body **26**, and supplies shaped object data indicating a shaped object in which coloring is performed on a surface where hue can be visually recognized from the outside to the shaping device **12**. The display unit **22** is an example of an image display device, and displays various types of information to the user of the control PC **14**. The display unit **22** can be considered as, for example, a configuration corresponding to a monitor of a computer. The operation unit **24** is configured to receive an input of information from the user by receiving an operation of the user. The operation unit **24** can be considered as, for example, a configuration corresponding to an input device such as a mouse or a keyboard of a computer. The body **26** is configured to execute various processes in the control PC **14**. The body **26** can be considered as, for example, a configuration corresponding to a body portion of a computer.

(21) Furthermore, in the present example, the control PC **14** is an example of a control device that controls the operation of the shaping device **12**, and for example, provides shaped object data received from the outside of the shaping system **10** to the shaping device **12**. According to such configuration, for example, the shaped object data can be appropriately provided to the shaping device **12**. Thus, the shaping of the shaped object can be appropriately executed in the shaping system **10**. In this case, for example, the control PC **14** may perform adjustment, and the like according to the configuration, state, and the like of the shaping device **12** on the shaped object data received from the outside, and provide the same to the shaping device **12**. Furthermore, in the present example, when creating a repair patch in the shaping device **12**, the control PC **14** provides shaped object data indicating the repair patch to the shaping device **12**. According to such configuration, for example, the shaping device **12** can be caused to appropriately create the repair patch. Furthermore, for example, the shaped object data may be generated in the control PC **14** according to, for example, an instruction, an operation, or the like of the user instead of being received from the outside of the shaping system **10**.

(22) For example, when causing the shaping device **12** to create a repair patch, consideration is made to generate shaped object data indicating the repair patch in the control PC **14**, and the like. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the shaped object data can be appropriately provided to the shaping device **12**.

(23) Next, a configuration of the head unit **102** in the shaping device **12** will be described in more detail. FIG. **1C** illustrates an example of a configuration of the head unit **102**. In the present example, the head unit **102** includes a plurality of inkjet heads **202**, a plurality of ultraviolet light

sources **204**, and a flattening roller **206**. The plurality of inkjet heads **202** include an inkjet head **202s**, an inkjet head **202w**, an inkjet head **202y**, an inkjet head **202m**, an inkjet head **202c**, an inkjet head **202k**, and an inkjet head **202t**, as shown in a distinguished manner with letters s to t in the figure. The plurality of inkjet heads **202** are, for example, arranged side by side in the main scanning direction with their positions in the sub scanning direction aligned. Furthermore, each inkjet head **202** includes a nozzle row, in which a plurality of nozzles are lined in a predetermined nozzle row direction, on a surface facing the shaping table **104**. Moreover, in the present example, the nozzle row direction is a direction parallel to the sub scanning direction.

(24) Among these inkjet heads **202**, the inkjet head **202s** is an inkjet head that ejects the material of the support layer **52**. For example, a known material for the support layer can be suitably used for the material of the support layer **52**. The inkjet head **202** other than the inkjet head **202s** is an inkjet head that ejects the material of the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, in the present example, the inkjet head **202** other than the inkjet head **202s** can be considered as, for example, an example of an ejection head that ejects the shaping material configuring the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, among the inkjet heads **202** other than the inkjet head **202s**, the inkjet head **202w** is an inkjet head that ejects white (W color) ink. Moreover, in the present example, the inkjet head **202w** is an example of a light reflective material head that ejects a light reflective material, which is a shaping material having light reflectivity. The white ink is an example of a light reflective material, and is used, for example, when forming a region (light reflecting region) having a property of reflecting light in the shaped object **50**. For example, the light reflecting region reflects light entering from the outside of the shaped object **50** when performing coloring with full color representation on the surface of the shaped object **50**. In this case, the full color representation can be considered as, for example, representation of colors performed with a possible combination of the subtractive color mixing method using the inks of process colors. The process color can be considered as, for example, a basic color used for color representation. The inkjet head **202y**, the inkjet head **202m**, the inkjet head **202c**, and the inkjet head **202k** (hereinafter referred to as the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k**) are inkjet heads for coloring used at the time of shaping the colored shaped object **50**. More specifically, the inkjet head **202y** ejects ink of yellow color (Y color). The inkjet head **202m** ejects ink of magenta color (M color). The inkjet head **202c** ejects ink of cyan color (C color). The inkjet head **202k** ejects ink of black color (K color). Furthermore, in the present example, the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k** are an example of a coloring material head that is an ejection head that ejects a colored material. In this case, the color material can be considered as, for example, a colored shaping material for coloring used at the time of shaping the colored shaped object. Each color of YMCK is an example of a process color. The ink of each color of Y, M, C, and K is an example of a color material. The ink of each color of Y, M, C, and K can be considered as, for example, a color ink for coloring. The inkjet head **202t** is an inkjet head that ejects a clear ink. The clear ink can be considered as, for example, an ink colorless and transparent (T) with respect to visible light. Furthermore, the clear ink can be considered as, for example, an ink to which a coloring material is not intentionally added.

(25) The plurality of ultraviolet light sources **204** are light sources (UV light sources) for curing ink, and generate an ultraviolet light that cures the ultraviolet-curable ink. The ultraviolet light source **204** can also be considered as, for example, a light source that irradiates the shaping material after ejected by the plurality of inkjet heads **202** in the shaping device **12** with the ultraviolet light. Moreover, in the present example, each of the plurality of ultraviolet light sources **204** is disposed on one end side and the other end side in the main scanning direction in the head unit **102** so as to sandwich the inkjet heads **202** in between. For example, UVLED (ultraviolet LED) and the like can be suitably used for the ultraviolet light source **204**. Furthermore, it is also conceivable to use a metal halide lamp, a mercury lamp, and the like for the ultraviolet light source **204**. The flattening roller **206** is a flattening unit for flattening the layer of ink formed during the shaping of the shaped object **50**. The flattening roller **206** can also be considered as, for example, a

configuration for flattening a layer formed of a material ejected from the ejection head. Furthermore, in the present example, the flattening roller **206** flattens the layer of ink by coming into contact with the surface of the layer of ink at the time of the main scan and removing one part of the ink before curing. The layer of ink forming the shaped object **50** can be appropriately formed, for example, by using the head unit **102** having the above configuration. Furthermore, for example, the shaped object **50** can be appropriately shaped by forming a plurality of layers of ink in an overlapping manner.

(26) The specific configuration of the head unit **102** is not limited to the configuration described above and can be variously modified. For example, the head unit **102** may further include an inkjet head for colors other than the above as an inkjet head for coloring. Furthermore, the arrangement of a plurality of inkjet heads in the head unit **102** can be variously modified. For example, the positions in the sub scanning direction of some inkjet heads may be shifted from the other inkjet heads.

(27) Next, the configuration of the shaped object **50** shaped by the shaping device **12** of the present example, the operation of repairing the shaped object **50** using the repair patch, and the like will be described in more detail. FIGS. **2A** to **2C** are views describing the shaped object **50** to be shaped by the shaping device **12** of the present example and the operation of repairing the shaped object **50**. FIG. **2A** is a view showing one example of the configuration of the shaped object **50**, and shows one example of the configuration of an X-Y cross section, which is a cross section of the shaped object **50** orthogonal to the layering direction (Z direction). In this case, the configuration of the Y-Z cross-section and the X-Z cross-section of the shaped object **50** perpendicular to the X direction and the Y direction also have a similar region.

(28) As described above, in the present example, the shaping device **12** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**) shapes the shaped object **50** in which at least the surface is colored using the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**) and the like. In this case, it can be considered that when referring to the surface of the shaped object **50** being colored, this means that, for example, at least one part of the region where hue can be visually recognized from the outside in the shaped object **50** is colored. Furthermore, in this case, the shaping device **12** shapes the shaped object **50** including a light reflecting region **152** and a region to be colored **154**, as shown in the figure. Moreover, the support layer **52** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**) is formed at the periphery of the shaped object **50**, and the like, as necessary.

(29) The light reflecting region **152** is a region formed on the inner side of the region to be colored **154** in a light reflecting manner, and reflects light entering from the outer side of the shaped object **50** through the region to be colored **154**. In the present example, the shaping device **12** forms the light reflecting region **152** inside the shaped object **50** using white ink ejected from the inkjet head **202w** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**). In this case, the light reflecting region **152** can be considered as, for example, a region also serving as an inner region. The inner region can be considered as, for example, a region configuring the inside of the shaped object **50**. In the modified example of the shaped object **50**, the inner region may be formed as a region different from the light reflecting region **152**. In this case, the shaping device **12** forms the inner region using, for example, an arbitrary ink other than the material of the support layer **52**. In addition, the light reflecting region **152** is formed at the periphery of the inner region. The region to be colored **154** is a region colored by inks for coloring ejected from the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k** at the surface of the shaped object **50**. In the present example, the shaping device **12** uses the ink for coloring ejected from the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k** and the clear ink ejected from the inkjet head **202t** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**) to form the region to be colored **154** at the periphery of the light reflecting region **152**. In this case, in the shaping device **12**, for example, various colors are represented by adjusting the ejection amount of the ink for coloring of each color to each position. Furthermore, the clear ink is used to compensate for a change in the amount of ink for coloring caused by the difference in color. According to such a configuration, for example, each position of the region to be colored **154** can

be appropriately colored with a desired color. This also makes it possible, for example, to appropriately shape a colored shaped object **50**.

(30) Here, after shaping the shaped object **50** in the shaping device **12**, various damages may occur in the shaped object **50**. For example, as in the shaped object **50** having the configuration shown in FIG. 2B, in the case of the shaped object **50** in which a portion thinner than other areas exist, damage easily occurs at the thin portion. FIG. 2B is a view showing one example of how damage occurs in the shaped object **50**, and shows one example of a state in which the damage occurs at the damaged area **60** in the shaped object **50** in which one part is thinned. In the figures, the view on the left side shows one example of the shaped object **50** before the damage occurs. The view on the right side shows one example of the shaped object **50** in a state where the damage occurred at the damaged area **60**.

(31) When such damage occurs in the shaped object **50**, for example, consideration is made to connect the damaged area with an adhesive, and the like when repairing through a simple method. However, in this case, it can be considered that the damage is likely to occur again as the strength of the repaired position (the damaged area **60** after repair) decreases. In addition, for example, the strength after the repair can be increased by not simply adhering the adhering area with an adhesive but by reinforcing with an adhesive tape or the like in a state where the damaged area **60** is connected. However, in this case, the appearance of the shaped object **50** is degraded as one part of the surface of the shaped object **50** is covered with the adhesive tape or the like. In particular, in a case where the colored shaped object **50** is repaired, the designability may be greatly deteriorated if the colored area is covered with an adhesive tape or the like.

(32) On the other hand, in the present example, for example, a thin film-shaped repair patch **300** as shown in FIG. 2C is created by the shaping device **12**, and the shaped object **50** is repaired using the repair patch **300**, so that degradation in appearance after the repair is suppressed while suppressing decrease in strength at the repair position. FIG. 2C illustrates an example of a configuration of the repair patch **300**. In the present example, the repair patch **300** is a patch-shaped member (repair patch), which is an example of an attachment member, and is attached to the shaped object **50** when repairing the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, the repair patch **300** is formed by being colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** at the time of repair in the shaped object **50**. When configured in such manner, for example, the strength at the repair position can be appropriately increased by attaching the repair patch **300** to the shaped object **50** to repair the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, by using the repair patch **300** colored in accordance with the color of the shaped object **50**, for example, the repair patch **300** can be made less noticeable, and degradation in appearance after repair can be appropriately suppressed. Thus, according to the present example, for example, the shaped object **50** can be more appropriately repaired.

(33) Coloring the repair patch **300** in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** at the time of repair in the shaped object **50** can be considered as, for example, coloring the repair patch **300** in accordance with the color, pattern, and the like of the surface of the shaped object **50** at the relevant portion. Furthermore, in FIG. 2B, an example of a shaped object **50** having a relatively simple shape is shown for the sake of convenience of illustration. As the shaped object **50** to be actually repaired, a shaped object **50** having a more complicated shape can be used. For example, it is also conceivable to use a shaped object such as a human-shaped figure indicating a person as the shaped object **50**. In this case, for example, the limbs, fingers, and the like of the figure can be considered as thin portions or the like that are likely to be damaged. Furthermore, more specifically, it is conceivable to execute the repair of the shaped object **50** carried out using the repair patch **300**, for example, as shown in FIGS. 3A to 3D.

(34) FIGS. 3A to 3D are views describing the operation of repairing the shaped object **50** using the repair patch **300** in more detail. FIGS. 3A and 3B illustrate an example of a configuration of the repair patch **300**.

(35) FIG. 3A illustrates an example of a state of the surface of the repair patch **300**. FIG. 3B is a cross-sectional view showing an example of a configuration of the repair patch **300**. As described above, in the present example, the repair patch **300** is created using the shaping device **12** (see FIGS. 1A to 1C) in the shaping system **10**. Therefore, the repair patch **300** can also be considered as, for example, a thin film-shaped shaped object or the like configured by a few number of layers of ink.

(36) In the present example, the repair patch **300** is a flexible film-like body including the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304**. In this case, the colored layer **302** is a layer to be colored in the repair patch **300**. Furthermore, as described above, in the present example, the repair patch **300** is colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** at the time of repair in the shaped object **50**. In this case, it can be considered that the colored layer **302** in the repair patch **300** is colored in this manner. Furthermore, in the present example, the coloring on the colored layer **302** is carried out same as or similar to the coloring on the surface of the shaped object **50**. More specifically, for the coloring on the surface of the shaped object **50**, for example, consideration is made to carry out the coloring so as to draw characters, patterns, and the like by differing the color according to the position on the surface. In this case, for example, as shown in FIG. 3A, the formation of the colored layer **302** is carried out by coloring so as to draw characters, patterns, and the like adapted to the characters and patterns on the surface of the shaped object **50** according to the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** in the shaped object **50** to be repaired. In this case, the clear ink is used to compensate for the change in the amount of ink for coloring caused by the difference in color also even at the time of forming the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300**, similarly to the time of forming the region to be colored **154** (see FIGS. 2A to 2C) in the shaped object **50**. Therefore, the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** can also be considered to be formed by further using, for example, the clear ink in addition to the colored ink (color ink) for coloring. According to such configuration, for example, the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** can be formed by being colored similarly to the region to be colored **154** of the shaped object **50**.

(37) The adhesive layer **304** is a layer for adhering the repair patch **300** with respect to the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, in the present example, the adhesive layer **304** is a layer that has adhesiveness at least at the time of attaching the repair patch **300** to the shaped object **50**. The manner of forming such an adhesive layer **304** will be described in more detail later. Furthermore, in the present example, the adhesive layer **304** is a white layer formed using a white ink ejected from the inkjet head **202w** (see FIGS. 1A to 1C). In this case, the adhesive layer **304** can be considered to also serve as, for example, a light reflective layer that reflects light entering from the outside through the colored layer **302**. Furthermore, for example, various colors can be more appropriately represented in the colored layer **302** by forming such an adhesive layer **304**. In addition, by covering the surface of the shaped object **50** with the white adhesive layer **304**, for example, characters and patterns on the surface of the shaped object **50** can be prevented from being transparent and visually recognized through the repair patch **300**. Thus, for example, the characters and patterns on the surface of the shaped object **50** and the characters and patterns drawn on the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** can be appropriately prevented from being doubly visually recognized.

(38) Furthermore, in the present example, when creating the repair patch **300** in the shaping device **12**, the colored layer **302** is formed first, and the adhesive layer **304** is formed thereon. According to such configuration, for example, the adhesive layer **304** having adhesiveness can be appropriately prevented from attaching to the shaping table **104** (see FIGS. 1A to 1C) in the shaping device **12**, and the like. Furthermore, in the present example, the repair patch **300** can also be considered as being shaped through the layered shaping method by the shaping device **12**. In this case, each of the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304** can be considered to be formed with a layer of ink. Furthermore, the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304** being created by

the shaping device **12** can be considered to, for example, overlap in the layering direction in which the material of shaping overlaps in the layered shaping method. Moreover, the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304** may be formed of a plurality of layers of ink overlapping in the layering direction. The thickness of the colored layer **302** in the repair patch **300** is preferably about the same as the thickness of the region to be colored **154** (see FIGS. 2A to 2C) in the shaped object **50**. In this case, the thickness of the region to be colored **154** in the shaped object **50** can be considered as, for example, a thickness in a normal direction orthogonal to the surface of the shaped object **50**. More specifically, the thickness of the colored layer **302** in the repair patch **300** may be considered as, for example, about 0.5 to 2 times, preferably about 0.7 to 1.5 times the thickness of the region to be colored **154** in the shaped object **50**. According to such configuration, for example, in the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300**, the color expression at the quality adapted to the region to be colored **154** in the shaped object **50** can be appropriately carried out.

(39) Furthermore, when repairing the shaped object **50** using such a repair patch **300**, for example, it is conceivable to attach the repair patch **300** as illustrated in FIGS. 3C and 3D. FIG. 3C shows an example of a manner of attaching the repair patch **300** to the shaped object **50** to be repaired. In FIG. 3C, the view on the left side shows the shaped object **50** to be repaired and the repair patch **300** at the time point when the attachment of the repair patch **300** is started. The view on the right side shows the shaped object **50** to be repaired and the repair patch **300** at the time point when the attachment of the repair patch **300** is completed.

(40) In the illustrated case, the shaped object **50** is damaged so that the thin portion is broken and divided into two. In this case, focusing on one of the divided shaped objects **50**, for example, it can be considered that a damage in which one part is defected has occurred. Furthermore, one of the divided shaped objects **50** can be considered as, for example, a shaped object to be repaired. In this case, the other of the divided shaped objects **50** can be considered as, for example, corresponding to a member to be attached to a defective area in the shaped object to be repaired. Furthermore, from such a viewpoint, hereinafter, at least one part of the portion used for repair in the shaped object **50** where the damage in which one part is defected has occurred is referred to as a repair target shaped object. The repair target shaped object can be considered as, for example, a configuration corresponding to at least one part of the shaped object **50** of before the damage occurs. Furthermore, a member to be attached to a defective area in the repair target shaped object is referred to as a defective portion part. In this case, for example, a portion excluding the defective portion part from the shaped object before the damage can be considered as a repair target shaped object.

(41) More specifically, when the damage as illustrated has occurred, one of the shaped objects **50** divided into two as described above can be considered as an example of the repair target shaped object. Furthermore, the other of the divided shaped objects **50** can be considered as an example of a defective portion part. Furthermore, in this case, for example, a portion deviated from the correction target shaped object due to damage can be considered as a defective portion part. By using such a defective portion part, for example, the defective portion part can be easily and appropriately prepared. Furthermore, depending on the state of damage, the quality required for repair, and the like, consideration is made to use a part newly created for repair instead of one part of the shaped object **50** before the damage occurred as the defective portion part. For example, depending on the manner the shaped object **50** is damaged, it may be difficult to use one part of the original shaped object **50** as the defective portion part. In such a case, the defective portion part is newly created (shaped) using, for example, the shaping device **12** (see FIGS. 1A to 1C) used to create the repair patch **300**.

(42) As shown in FIG. 3C, in the present example, when repairing the shaped object **50**, the divided shaped objects **50** are connected at the position of the damaged area **60**, and the repair patch **300** is attached thereon. Such an operation can be considered as, for example, an operation of attaching the defective portion part to the repair target shaped object and covering at least one part of the

boundary portion with the repair patch **300**, and the like. Furthermore, the manner of attaching the repair patch **300** can be considered as, for example, being attached to at least one part of the surfaces of the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part. In addition, the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** can be considered to function as, for example, a layer for adhering the repair patch **300** to the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part. Moreover, in this case, the other is preferably adhered to one of the divided shaped objects **50** using an adhesive before attaching the repair patch **300**. According to such configuration, for example, the strength of the shaped object **50** after the repair can be more appropriately enhanced.

(43) In this case, the state of the cross-section of the shaped object **50** changes, for example, as shown in FIG. **3D** between before and after attaching the repair patch **300**. FIG. **3D** is a cross-sectional view showing an example of a configuration of a cross-section of the shaped object **50** and the repair patch **300** at a position of attaching the repair patch **300**. In FIG. **3D**, the view on the left side shows a cross-section of the shaped object **50** at a time point before attaching the repair patch **300** after attaching the other to one of the divided shaped objects **50**. In this case, the cross-section of the shaped object **50** has a configuration in which the region to be colored **154** surrounds the periphery of the light reflecting region **152** in the same manner as the shaped object **50** before the damage occurs. Furthermore, in FIG. **3D**, the view on the right side shows the cross-section of the shaped object **50** and the repair patch **300** after the other is attached to one of the divided shaped objects **50** and then the repair patch **300** is further attached.

(44) In this case, as shown in the figure, the adhesive layer **304** and the colored layer **302** in the repair patch **300** overlap the outer side of the region to be colored **154** in the shaped object **50** in this order at the position where the repair patch **300** is attached.

(45) Furthermore, as described above, in the present example, the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** is formed to also serve as the light reflective layer using the white ink. In this case, at the position where the repair patch **300** is attached, the color of the region to be colored **154** of the shaped object **50** is concealed by the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** and is not visually recognized from the outside. Therefore, the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** can also be considered to function as, for example, a concealing layer that conceals the color of the surface of the shaped object **50**. Furthermore, in this case, in the repair patch **300**, the color colored on the colored layer **302** can be considered to become, for example, the color of the shaped object **50** after the repair as the colored layer **302** comes on the outer side of the adhesive layer **304**. As described above, in the present example, the colored layer **302** in the repair patch **300** is formed with a color that matches the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** at the time of repair in the shaped object **50**. Thus, according to such configuration, for example, the color of the shaped object **50** after the repair at the position of attaching the repair patch **300** can be the same color as before the repair. Thus, for example, the repair of the shaped object **50** using the repair patch **300** can be appropriately performed while appropriately preventing the deterioration in the appearance of the shaped object **50** after the repair by attaching the repair patch **300**.

(46) Next, the operation of repairing the shaped object **50** will be described in more detail. FIG. **4** is a flowchart showing an example of the operation of repairing the shaped object **50**, and shows an example of the operation of repairing the shaped object **50** in which the damage where one part is defected has occurred. Furthermore, hereinafter, the shaped object **50** to be repaired will be appropriately referred to as a repair target shaped object and described. In this case, as described above, the repair target shaped object can be considered as, for example, at least one part of the damaged shaped object **50**, and the like. Furthermore, in the present example, this repair operation is an example of an operation of a repairing method for the shaped object **50** of repairing the shaped object **50** shaped by the shaping device **12**.

(47) In the present example, in the operation of repairing the repair target shaped object, first, a defective portion part to be attached to the repair target shaped object is prepared (S**102**). The operation in step S**102** is an example of the operation in the preparing stage. Furthermore, as

described above, it is conceivable to use one part of the shaped object **50** before damage as the defective portion part. In this case, for example, a portion separated from the shaped object **50** due to damage can be considered as a defective portion part. Furthermore, in the present example, in step **S102**, each part of the shaped object **50** separated by the damage is collected, a part thereof is treated as a repair target shaped object, and the other part is treated as a defective portion part to prepare a defective portion part. Moreover, as described above, depending on the manner in which the shaped object **50** is damaged, consideration is made to newly shape the defective portion part using the shaping device **12** without using one part of the original shaped object **50** as the defective portion part. In this case, for example, the operation of shaping the defective portion part can be considered as an operation of preparing the defective portion part, and the like.

(48) Furthermore, after preparing the defective portion part, patch data that is data indicating the repair patch **300** is generated (**S104**), and the shaping device **12** is caused to perform the shaping operation based on the patch data, so that the shaping device **12** is caused to create the repair patch **300** (**S106**). The operations in steps **S104** and **S106** are an example of the operation in the attachment member creating stage. In step **S104** of the present example, the control PC **14** in the shaping system **10** is caused to generate the patch data. The operation of generating the slice data will be described in more detail later. In step **S106**, the control PC **14** is caused to provide the patch data to the shaping device **12** to cause the shaping device **12** to perform the shaping operation based on the patch data.

(49) Here, causing the shaping device **12** to create the repair patch **300** can be considered as, for example, creating the repair patch **300** using the shaping device **12** capable of shaping a shaped object colored by the layered shaping method. In addition, as described above, in the present example, the repair patch **300** includes the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304**. Among these layers, the adhesive layer **304** can be considered as, for example, a layer having different properties from the layer of ink formed at the time of normal shaping in the shaping device **12**. More specifically, as described above, in the shaping device **12** of the present example, an ultraviolet-curable ink is used as a shaping material. In this case, for example, the ultraviolet-curable ink can be brought to a state having adhesiveness by being irradiated with the ultraviolet light of a smaller amount of light than when being completely cured. Therefore, in the present example, the adhesive layer **304** of the repair patch **300** is formed by bringing the ultraviolet-curable ink into such an adhesive state. Furthermore, in the present example, in step **S106**, the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** are formed using the ink ejected from any of the plurality of inkjet heads **202** in the shaping device **12**, as described above. In this case, the colored layer **302** is formed by irradiating a sufficient amount of ultraviolet light from the ultraviolet light source **204** in the shaping device **12** and curing the ink to a state not having adhesiveness. On the other hand, when forming the adhesive layer **304** to be formed on the colored layer **302**, the white ink to be used for forming the adhesive layer **304** is not completely cured, but the viscosity is increased to a state having adhesiveness by irradiating the ultraviolet light of a smaller amount of light than that at the time of forming the colored layer **302** from the ultraviolet light source **204**. According to such configuration, for example, the adhesive layer **304** having adhesiveness can be appropriately formed using the ultraviolet-curable ink, which is the shaping material used at the time of shaping the normal shaped object in the shaping device **12**. The state in which the ultraviolet-curable ink is not completely cured and the viscosity thereof is increased to a state having adhesiveness can be considered as, for example, a state in which the ink is semi-cured (precured).

(50) In addition, after creating the repair patch **300**, the defective portion part is adhered to the repair target shaped object using the known adhesive to attach the defective portion part to the repair target shaped object (**S108**). The operation in step **S108** is an example of the operation in the adhering stage.

(51) Furthermore, in the present example, the repair patch **300** is further attached so as to cover at

least one part of the boundary portion between the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part while the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part are brought into contact with each other by adhesion (S110). The operation in step S110 is an example of the operation in the attaching stage. Furthermore, as described above, in the present example, the adhesive layer 304 in the repair patch 300 is formed in a state where the ultraviolet-curable ink is not completely cured. Therefore, in the present example, in step S110, after attaching the repair patch 300 to the repair target shaped object, the repair patch 300 is further irradiated with ultraviolet light to cure the ultraviolet-curable ink in the adhesive layer 304. Thus, for example, the curing of the ultraviolet-curable ink used for forming the adhesive layer 304 is completed, and the repair patch 300 is fixed to the repair target shaped object. According to such configuration, for example, the repair patch 300 can be more appropriately attached to the repair target shaped object. Thus, for example, the repair of the repair target shaped object can be appropriately carried out.

(52) Next, the operation of generating patch data in step S104 will be described in more detail. As described above, in the present example, the repair patch 300 is colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch 300 at the time of repair in the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part, and formed. Furthermore, in this case, it is conceivable to create the shape of the repair patch 300 according to the shape of the repair target shaped object and the shape of the defective portion part. Therefore, in the present example, such a repair patch 300 is created by creating the repair patch 300 based on the data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object. In this case, the time of shaping the repair target shaped object can be considered as, for example, the time of shaping the shaped object 50 before the damage occurs by the shaping device 12. Furthermore, in the present example, shaped object data used in the shaping device 12 is used as such data. In this case, the shaped object data can be considered as, for example, data indicating the shape and color at the time of shaping the shaped object 50 to be repaired. The shaped object data can also be considered as, for example, 3D data indicating the entire shaped object 50 to be repaired. In the present example, the patch data is generated by the operation shown in FIG. 5 by the control PC 14 in the shaping system 10 based on the shaped object data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object.

(53) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating an example of an operation of generating the patch data. In the operation shown in the flowchart, first, 3D data indicating the entire shaped object 50 is acquired (S202). More specifically, in step S202 of the present example, the control PC 14 acquires the shaped object data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object as 3D data indicating the entire shaped object 50 according to a user's instruction or the like. Then, the control PC 14 displays an image showing at least one part of the repair target shaped object on the display unit 22 based on the acquired shaped object data (S204). The operation of step S204 is an example of an operation of indicating the repair target shaped object to the user.

(54) In this case, for example, it is conceivable to display the entire shaped object 50 to be the repair target shaped object on the display unit 22. Furthermore, for example, one part of the shaped object 50 may be displayed on the display unit 22 in an enlarged manner according to an instruction of the user. Moreover, in the present example, in step S204, it can be considered that the shaped object 50 before the damage occurs is displayed as the repair target shaped object to be displayed on the display unit 22.

(55) Furthermore, in the present example, a position to be repaired due to occurrence of damage is determined according to an instruction of a user. Therefore, after displaying the shaped object 50 on the display unit 22 in step S204, for example, the control PC 14 receives designation (selection) of a repair position, which is a position to be repaired in the repair target shaped object, from the user according to the user's operation on the operation unit 24 (S206). The operation in step S206 is an example of the operation in the repair position designating stage. The operation of step S206 can be considered as, for example, an operation of displaying an image showing at least one part of the repair target shaped object on the image display device and receiving the designation of the repair

position from the user. With this configuration, for example, the repair position corresponding to the repair patch **300** to be created can be appropriately determined. After receiving the designation of the repair position, the control PC **14** determines the shape of the repair patch **300** and the color of each position in the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** in accordance with the designated repair position (S208). Then, the control PC **14** generates shaped object data for the repair patch **300** as patch data indicating the repair patch **300** to be created based on the determined shape and color (S210). In this case, the shaped object data generated in step S210 can also be considered as, for example, 3D data indicating the shape and color of the repair patch **300**.

(56) According to such configuration, for example, the color, shape, and the like of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** in the repair target shaped object can be appropriately acquired based on the shaped object data indicating the shaped object **50**. In addition, for example, the repair position can be appropriately determined by receiving the designation of the repair position by the user. Thus, for example, the shape and color of the repair patch **300** adapted to the repair position of the shaped object **50** can be appropriately determined. Thus, according to the present example, for example, the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** can be appropriately colored in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** in the shaped object **50** to be repaired. Furthermore, in the present example, the control PC **14** provides the shaped object data for the repair patch **300** to the shaping device **12** to cause the shaping device **12** to create the repair patch **300** based on the shape and color determined in step S208. According to such configuration, for example, the repair patch **300** corresponding to the shape and color of the shaped object **50** and the repair position can be appropriately created.

(57) The operation of creating the patch data is not limited to the operation described above, and various changes can be made. For example, in the operation described above with reference to FIG. 5, the control PC **14** generates the patch data indicating the repair patch **300** based on the shaped object data used at the time of shaping the repair target shaped object. However, in a modified example of the operation of generating the patch data, the patch data may be generated without using such shaped object data. In this case, for example, it is conceivable to directly acquire the shape and color of the repair target shaped object by performing 3D scanning on the damaged shaped object **50** to be repaired. More specifically, in this case, in step S202 in the operation shown in FIG. 5, scan data, which is data obtained by 3D scanning the damaged shaped object **50**, is generated as data indicating the shape and color of the repair target shaped object. In this case, the operation of step S202 can be considered as, for example, an example of the operation in the data generating stage. In this case, the patch data is generated based on the scan data by performing the operations of step S204 and thereafter using the scan data instead of the shaped object data indicating the shaped object **50** before the damage. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the shape of the repair patch **300** and the color of each position of the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** can be appropriately determined based on the scan data. Furthermore, the repair patch **300** adapted to the shape and color of the shaped object **50** and the repair position can be appropriately created based on the determined shape and color.

(58) In addition, when the patch data is generated based on the scan data, it is preferable that a portion corresponding to the defective portion part described above is also a target of the scan.

(59) More specifically, in this case, for example, consideration is made to perform the 3D scan with the defective portion part attached to the repair target shaped object corresponding to one part of the shaped object **50**. According to such configuration, for example, the shape and color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** in the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part can be appropriately acquired. Thus, for example, the shape of the repair patch **300** and the color of each position of the colored layer **302** can be more appropriately determined. Furthermore, in this case, for example, it is conceivable to perform the 3D scan in a state where the defective portion part is temporarily fixed to the repair target shaped object. As a method of 3D scan, for example, it is conceivable to use various known methods. Furthermore, in this case, for example, it

is conceivable to perform 3D scanning or the like using a plurality of photographs captured from directions different from each other using a smartphone or the like. According to such configuration, for example, the 3D scan can be easily executed without using a dedicated expensive device or the like. The patch data may be generated by a computer other than, for example, the control PC **14**. In this case, the control PC **14** causes the shaping device **12** to create the repair patch **300** by providing the patch data received from the outside to the shaping device **12**.

(60) Furthermore, in the operation of creating the patch data, for example, consideration is also made to determine the repair position based on the shaped object data indicating the shaped object **50** before damage and the state of the damaged shaped object **50**. More specifically, in this case, it is conceivable to detect the position where the damage has occurred (damaged position) based on the shaped object data used at the time of shaping the shaped object **50** to be repaired and the image (e.g., photograph etc.) indicating the damaged shaped object **50**. In this case, a computer (e.g., the control PC **14**) that executes an operation of creating the patch data determines, for example, a candidate for a repair position based on a detected damaged position, and displays the candidate on the display unit **22**. Then, an instruction to change or correct the repair position is received from the user as necessary, and the repair position is determined based on the received instruction. With this configuration, for example, the repair position can be more easily and appropriately determined.

(61) The configuration and the like of the repair patch **300** are not limited to the configuration described above, and can be variously changed. FIGS. **6A** to **6C** are views describing a modified example of the configuration and the like of the repair patch **300**. FIGS. **6A** and **6B** illustrate a modified example of the configuration of the repair patch **300**. Other than the points described below, in FIGS. **6A** to **6C**, the configurations denoted with the same reference numbers as FIGS. **1A** to **5** may have features same as or similar to the configurations in FIGS. **1A** to **5**. In the above description, the configuration in which the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** is formed using the white ink to cause the adhesive layer **304** to also serve as the light reflective layer has been mainly described for the configuration of the repair patch **300**. However, in a modified example of the configuration of the repair patch **300**, the adhesive layer **304** of the repair patch **300** may be formed in a color other than white using an ink other than white. In this case, for example, it is conceivable to form a colorless transparent adhesive layer **304** using clear ink. In this case, for example, as shown in FIG. **6A**, it is conceivable to create the repair patch **300** having a configuration of further including a light reflective layer **306** in addition to the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304**. More specifically, in this case, it is conceivable to form the white light reflective layer **306** using a white ink between the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304**. In this case, it is conceivable that only the adhesive layer **304** among the layers in the repair patch **300** is formed to have adhesiveness, and the colored layer **302** and the light reflective layer **306** are irradiated with a sufficient amount of ultraviolet light to be formed in a state having no adhesiveness. Even when configured in such manner, the colored repair patch **300** can be appropriately created similarly to the shaped object **50**.

(62) In addition, in FIGS. **1A** to **5**, an example of a simple shape is illustrated for the shape of the repair patch **300** for the sake of convenience of illustration. However, as described above, consideration is made to have the shape of the repair patch **300** adapted to the repair position in the shaped object **50**. Therefore, as for the shape of the repair patch **300**, for example, it is conceivable to adopt various shapes adapted to the repair position, such as the shape illustrated in FIG. **6B**. In this case, it is also conceivable to create the repair patch **300** having a more complicated shape as necessary.

(63) Furthermore, in the above description, the manner of forming the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300** has been mainly described for a method of forming using an ultraviolet-curable ink used as a shaping material at the time of shaping a normal shaped object. However, in a modified example of the manner of forming the adhesive layer **304**, for example, consideration is also made to form the adhesive layer **304** with an adhesive material that is not used as a shaping

material at the time of shaping a normal shaped object. In this case, the material not used as the shaping material at the time of shaping the normal shaped object can be considered as, for example, a material not used when shaping the same shaped object as the repair target shaped object. More specifically, the adhesive material is, for example, a material of the adhesive layer **304** in the repair patch **300**, and can be considered as a material not used when forming the same region as the light reflecting region **152** and the region to be colored **154** (see FIGS. **2A** to **2C**) in the shaped object **50** to be repaired. Furthermore, in this case, it is conceivable to create the repair patch **300** using the shaping device **12** having a configuration capable of further ejecting the adhesive material in addition to the shaping material used at the time of shaping the normal shaped object. More specifically, in this case, for example, it is conceivable to create the repair patch **300** using the shaping device **12** including the head unit **102** having the configuration illustrated in FIG. **6C**. FIG. **6C** shows a modified example of the configuration of the head unit **102** in the shaping device **12** (see FIGS. **1A** to **1C**). In the present modified example, the head unit **102** further includes an inkjet head **208** in addition to the inkjet heads **202s** to **202t** in the head unit **102** having the configuration shown in FIG. **1C** as the plurality of inkjet heads. Furthermore, the ultraviolet light source **204** for the inkjet head **208** is further provided on one side and the other side in the main scanning direction with respect to the inkjet head **208**. In this case, the shaping device **12** can be considered as, for example, a configuration of performing shaping without using the inkjet head **208** when shaping a shaped object same as or similar to the shaped object **50** to be repaired, and using the inkjet head **208** when creating the repair patch **300**.

(64) Furthermore, in the present modified example, the inkjet head **208** is an example of an adhesive material head that ejects an adhesive material used as a material of the adhesive layer **304**. As the repair patch **300**, for example, it is conceivable to form the repair patch **300** having a configuration in which the light reflective layer **306** and the adhesive layer **304** are separated as in the configuration illustrated in FIGS. **6A** to **6C**. More specifically, at the time of forming the repair patch **300**, the shaping device **12** forms the colored layer **302** using, for example, the colored ink ejected from the inkjet heads **202y** to **202k** and the clear ink ejected from the inkjet head **202t**. In addition, the light reflective layer **306** is formed on the colored layer **302** using the white ink ejected from the inkjet head **202w**. Then, the adhesive layer **304** is formed on the light reflective layer **306** using the adhesive material ejected from the inkjet head **208**. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the repair patch **300** used for repairing the shaped object **50** can be appropriately created.

(65) In the present modified example, consideration is made to use, for example, an ink that fixes in a state having adhesiveness at the ejection position as the adhesive material ejected from the inkjet head **208**. As such an adhesive material, for example, it is conceivable to use an ultraviolet-curable ink or the like that maintains adhesiveness even when ultraviolet light is sufficiently emitted and curing is completed. More specifically, as such an adhesive material, for example, it is conceivable to use a liquid same as or similar to a known ultraviolet-curable ink (primer ink) for forming a base. As such a primer ink, for example, it is conceivable to use a known primer ink (e.g., PR-200 type ink etc.) sold by MIMAKI ENGINEERING CO., LTD. In addition, when using the repair patch **300** including such an adhesive layer **304**, it can be considered that the adhesive layer **304** at the time point when the creation of the repair patch **300** is completed is not in a semi-cured state or the like but in a state in which curing is completed. Therefore, in this case, consideration is made to complete the attachment of the repair patch **300** to the repair target shaped object without further irradiating the ultraviolet light at the time of repairing the shaped object. Even when configured in such manner, for example, the repair patch **300** can be appropriately attached to the repair target shaped object. In a further modified example of the configuration of the shaping device **12**, for example, consideration is made to use an adhesive material that is not ultraviolet-curable, and the like as the adhesive material that is not used as the shaping material at the time of shaping the normal shaped object.

(66) Next, supplementary description regarding each configuration described above will be made. In addition, hereinafter, various modified examples are included and referred to as a configuration of the present example, for the sake of convenience of description. As described above, in the present example, the shaped object is repaired using at least one part of the damaged shaped object as the shaped object to be repaired. In this case, for example, the strength of the shaped object after the repair can be appropriately enhanced by attaching the repair patch **300** created using the shaping device **12** to at least one part of the repair position in the shaped object. Furthermore, by using the repair patch **300** including at least the colored layer **302** and the adhesive layer **304**, for example, the shaping device **12** can easily and appropriately create the repair patch **300** that is appropriately colored and can be adhered to the shaped object. Furthermore, the colored layer **302** of the repair patch **300** is colored and formed in accordance with the color of the portion covered by the repair patch **300** in the shaped object to be repaired, so that, for example, the repair patch **300** can be appropriately prevented from being excessively conspicuous in the shaped object after the repair.

(67) In this regard, if the repair patch **300** is created using the shaping device **12** capable of shaping the shaped object, for example, a new shaped object having the same shape and color as the damaged shaped object may be created instead of repairing using the repair patch **300**. However, depending on the intended purpose of the shaped object and the like, it may be more preferable to repair than to create a new shaped object. More specifically, for example, when shaping a new shaped object, it is conceivable that the amount of ink used as the shaping material increases, leading to a large amount of cost. Furthermore, in a case where the shaped object that has been subjected to additional processing and the like after being shaped by the shaping device **12** is damaged, the same shaped object as the damaged shaped object may not be shaped only by performing the shaping in the shaping device **12**. On the other hand, according to the present example, the repair of the shaped object can be appropriately carried out at low cost by using the repair patch **300**. Furthermore, in this case, the repair of the shaped object carried out in the present example can be considered as, for example, a method particularly suitable when carrying out a simple repair carried out without increasing cost, and the like.

(68) Furthermore, as described above, in the present example, the repair patch **300** is created using the shaping device **12** capable of executing the shaping of the shaped object by the layered shaping method. In this case, for example, it is conceivable to create the repair patch **300** using the shaping device **12** (shaping device of the same machine body) that shaped the shaped object to be repaired. Furthermore, the shaping device **12** used to create the repair patch **300** may be a shaping device **12** different from the machine body that shaped the shaped object to be repaired. In this case, for example, the shaping device **12** of the same model as the machine body that shaped the shaped object or the shaping device **12** of a compatible model is preferably used. According to such configuration, for example, the repair patch **300** colored similarly to the shaped object to be repaired can be more appropriately created. Furthermore, in this case, for example, the thickness of each layer of ink layered in the layered shaping method is preferably the same at the time of shaping the shaped object and at the time of creating the repair patch **300**. According to such configuration, for example, the repair patch **300** colored in accordance with the shaped object can be more appropriately created. Furthermore, depending on the quality required for repair, and the like, the repair patch **300** may be created using the shaping device **12** that is not the same model or compatible model as the shaping device that shaped the shaped object. Even in such a case, the repair of the shaped object can be appropriately carried out by using the repair patch **300** colored in accordance with the surface of the shaped object.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(69) The present disclosure can be suitably used, for example, in a repairing method for a shaped object.

Claims

1. A repairing method for a shaped object for repairing a shaped object shaped by a shaping device, the repairing method comprising: preparing a defective portion part which is a member to be attached to a defective area in a repair target shaped object which is the shaped object where a damage in which one part is defected has occurred; creating an attachment member which is a member to be attached to at least one part of surfaces of the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part; and attaching the attachment member so as to cover at least one part of a boundary portion between the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part in a state where the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part are brought into contact with each other; wherein at least one part of a surface of the repair target shaped object is colored; in the step of attaching the attachment member, the attachment member including an adhesive layer and a colored layer is created using a shaping device capable of shaping the shaped object colored by a layered shaping method, wherein the adhesive layer is a layer for adhering the attachment member to the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part, and the colored layer is a layer colored and formed according to a color of a portion of the shaped object to be covered by the attachment member; the repair target shaped object includes: a region to be colored subjected to coloring at a surface of the repair target shaped object; and a light reflecting region formed on an inner side of the region to be colored in a light reflecting manner; the shaping device used in the step of attaching the attachment member is a device that ejects an ultraviolet-curable material as a shaping material, and includes: a plurality of ejection heads each of which ejects the shaping material, and an ultraviolet light source that irradiates the ejected shaping material with ultraviolet light; the plurality of ejection heads include at least: a coloring material head that ejects a color material which is a colored shaping material for coloring; and a light reflective material head that ejects a light reflective material which is a shaping material having light reflectivity; in the step of attaching the attachment member, the colored layer is formed using at least the color material ejected from the coloring material head, the adhesive layer is formed using the shaping material ejected from any one of the plurality of ejection heads, and at a time of forming the adhesive layer; the shaping material is irradiated with ultraviolet light from the ultraviolet light source to increase viscosity of the shaping material to a state having adhesiveness; and after attaching the attachment member to the repair target shaped object, the attachment member is irradiated with ultraviolet light to cure the shaping material in the adhesive layer.
2. The repairing method for the shaped object according to claim 1, further comprising: receiving a designation of a repair position, which is a position to be repaired in the repair target shaped object, from a user, wherein an image showing at least one part of the repair target shaped object is displayed on an image display device, and the designation of the repair position is received from the user; and wherein in the step of attaching the attachment member, a shape of the attachment member and a color of each position in the colored layer are determined in accordance with the received designation of the repair position, and the attachment member is created based on the determined shape and color.
3. The repairing method for the shaped object according to claim 1, wherein in the step of attaching the attachment member, a color of each position in the colored layer of the attachment member is determined based on shaped object data used at a time of shaping the repair target shaped object, the data indicating the shape and color of the repair target shaped object, and the attachment member is created based on the determined color.
4. The repairing method for the shaped object according to claim 1, further comprising: generating scan data which is data obtained by 3D scanning the repair target shaped object; wherein in the step of attaching the attachment member, a color of each position in the colored layer of the attachment member is determined based on the generated scan data, and the attachment member is created

based on the determined color.

5. A repairing method for a shaped object for repairing a shaped object shaped by a shaping device, the repairing method comprising: preparing a defective portion part which is a member to be attached to a defective area in a repair target shaped object which is the shaped object where a damage in which one part is defected has occurred; creating an attachment member which is a member to be attached to at least one part of surfaces of the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part; and attaching the attachment member so as to cover at least one part of a boundary portion between the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part in a state where the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part are brought into contact with each other; wherein at least one part of a surface of the repair target shaped object is colored; in the step of attaching the attachment member, the attachment member including an adhesive layer and a colored layer is created using a shaping device capable of shaping the shaped object colored by a layered shaping method, wherein the adhesive layer is a layer for adhering the attachment member to the repair target shaped object and the defective portion part, and the colored layer is a layer colored and formed according to a color of a portion of the shaped object to be covered by the attachment member; the repair target shaped object includes: a region to be colored subjected to coloring at a surface of the repair target shaped object; and a light reflecting region formed on an inner side of the region to be colored in a light reflecting manner: the shaping device used in the step of attaching the attachment member includes a plurality of ejection heads each of which ejects the shaping material; the plurality of ejection heads include at least: a coloring material head that ejects a color material which is a colored shaping material for coloring, a light reflective material head that ejects a light reflective material which is a shaping material having light reflectivity; and an adhesive material head that ejects an adhesive material, which is a material of the adhesive layer in the attachment member, the adhesive material not being used when forming a same region as each of the region to be colored and the light reflecting region in the repair target shaped object; and in the step of attaching the attachment member, the colored layer is formed using at least the color material ejected from the coloring material head, and the adhesive layer is formed using the adhesive material ejected from the adhesive material head.
